about twenty thousand inhabitants but I speak from guess. It is more remarkable as being the market for the district of which it is the capital (Karadangh) than as a town of itself. The bazars for the size of the place were exceedingly well supplied and I was pleased to see the quantities of blankets and other English manufactures exposed for sale in the shops. There is also there a very curious mosque or rather building over the tomb of some saint just outside the town. I could not learn the name of the saint, but the building is of great antiquity and was constructed by order of one of the former kings of Persia. It is a dome of great height and has an archway reaching nearly from top to base supported on each side by columns which are covered with a sort of blue tile something like the Dutch tiles I have seen in old fashioned houses in England but of far brighter colour. The building is kept in repair by the product of some lands which were left by the pious founder for that purpose and have never been interfered with for centuries.

There is a most superb view of the mountain of Savelan from some places near Ahar this mountain is never free from snow and is said to be 12,000[50] feet above the level of the sea. On the very summit of the mountain is entombed (if I may use the expression for the way in which this gentleman is preserved) a prophet. The people who have deposited him there whoever they may have been, appear first to have hewn a cistern out of the solid rock then placed the body in it with the clothes on and afterwards filled it with water which of course soon became solid ice. In the winter this ice becomes, no doubt, of a great thickness but at that time no one can ascend the mountain to look at him. But in the summer when the ice thaws to only a few feet thickness or sometimes even thinner, the prophet appears as if he was enclosed in a fine glass case and appears as perfect as the day he was put in. I had this account both from the Persians and from an English friend of mine who had ascended the mountain to see the saint. The Englishman had lost all his teeth by disease in India and wanted to break away the ice to get some of the old mans teeth to set in his own mouth; to the great horror of the guides who would by no means permit such a sacreligious proceeding. The age in which this prophet lived is not known nor his name but the Persians claim for him greater antiquity than the Christian era. The place is much frequented by pilgrims and it is said that in some long summers from the melting of the ice, a part of the clothes are uncovered and shreds of these have been carried away by the pious and numerous and well attested are the cures and miracles which have been performed by these relics!!!

[50] Savalan Dagh is listed as being 14,000 feet above sea level. It has proven a fruitless undertaking to attempt to verify the following legend. It seems slightly incredible that any European should consider such means as those related here for dental replacements, in A. D. 1839.

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